

MAHMUD ABDUL GAFAR

Software Engineer · Founding Member, Ketapay

Abuja, Nigeria | 08037646510 | mahhir09@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/abdul-gafarmahmud | github.com/Maheer11 | maheero.pages.dev

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer and founding team member of Ketapay, an escrow platform securing online payments for Nigerian buyers and sellers. I build responsive, user-centered web and mobile products on TypeScript/React/Next.js frontends and Supabase-powered backends and I test what I ship: hands-on QA across UI, API, and end-to-end flows, including AI-assisted exploratory testing with MCP-connected browser tooling. Known as a fast learner who understands a system before testing it, and a dependable problem-solver who turns ambiguous ideas into shipped, reliable software.

CORE STRENGTHS

- ▶ Full-stack engineering — TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Java/Spring Boot, PHP; component-based architecture and clean API integration.
- ▶ Quality engineering — end-to-end and exploratory testing across web and mobile: Playwright (E2E), Postman (API), and AI-assisted browser testing via the Model Context Protocol (Chrome DevTools MCP + Claude Code).
- ▶ Code fluency — reads and reasons about unfamiliar codebases quickly to debug, refactor, and extend systems with confidence.
- ▶ Problem framing & solution design — breaks ambiguous problems into structured, shippable plans; tests feasibility before promising.
- ▶ Product ownership — takes features from concept and MVP through deployment, support, and iteration.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Builder — WatchList: AI Food-Label Scanner

2026

Personal Product — Supabase Edge Functions · Claude (Anthropic API) · Next.js · watchlist-deltaone.vercel.app

- ▶ Designed, built, and deployed WatchList, a food-label scanning web app for everyday shoppers in Nigeria: photograph a product's ingredient panel and get a plain-English breakdown, with ingredients “worth watching” flagged and the general, true-for-everyone reason why.
- ▶ Architected a deliberately minimal, stateless backend: a single Supabase Edge Function as the secure boundary — receiving the image, calling Claude (Opus 4.8) via Anthropic's API with a tightly constrained prompt, and returning a structured breakdown. No database, no stored user photos — a privacy-first pilot choice.
- ▶ Engineered the safety layer in the prompt itself: declines to guess unreadable labels, flags ingredients as “generally worth watching” rather than giving personal medical advice, and cites no numbers without a named source.
- ▶ Ran a friends-and-family pilot via a deployed URL against real Nigerian packaging — faded, curved, glare-hit labels — validating vision-model extraction on messy real-world input.

Builder — ConstructHQ: Construction Workforce & Project Management Platform

2026

Personal Project — Next.js · Tailwind CSS · Prisma

- ▶ Designed and built ConstructHQ, a construction-intelligence web platform giving construction companies a single dashboard for daily operations: attendance, project tracking, HR, expenses, documents, and staff profiles.
- ▶ Implemented core modules end-to-end: clock-in/out attendance tracking, project and task tracking with team assignment, leave request and approval workflows, expense submission and approval, document management with PDF preview, a performance leaderboard, and role-based staff profiles with permissioned edit access.
- ▶ Directed an AI-assisted, spec-driven UI redesign (Claude Code): defined a consistent card-based design system, wrote page-by-page specs and constraints, and shipped the redesign incrementally without altering existing business logic, API calls, or database queries.
- ▶ Diagnosed and resolved a production configuration issue independently — traced a 500 error on the expense-submission flow through demo-mode logic and environment variables to a placeholder database connection string, then provisioned and connected a real Postgres instance.

- ▶ Refined the project's portfolio showcase presentation, reworking card image layouts for both desktop and mobile so the UI reads clearly to recruiters at a glance.

QA Engineer — AI-Assisted Exploratory Testing (MCP)

2026

Ketapay — Escrow Platform (Web & Mobile)

- ▶ Built an AI-assisted exploratory testing workflow by connecting Google Chrome's DevTools MCP (Model Context Protocol) server to Claude Code, enabling an AI agent to drive and inspect live browser sessions against Ketapay's web application.
- ▶ Directed agent-driven inspection of critical user flows — escrow invite sending, KYC steps, and the profile dashboard in sync with escrow creation and ratings — surfacing console errors, network-request failures, and rendered UI state at a diagnosis speed a manual pass can't match.
- ▶ Operated the full MCP architecture hands-on — host (Claude Code), client, and tool-exposing server — including the permission and safety considerations of giving an AI agent live browser access.

Founding Member & Software Engineer

2025 – Present

Ketapay — Escrow Platform for Nigerian Buyers & Sellers · ketapay.com

- ▶ Joined Ketapay as a founding team member of an escrow platform that protects online transactions between Nigerian businesses by holding buyer funds securely until both parties confirm a completed sale.
- ▶ Designed and built the public marketing site and product story pages (TypeScript, Next.js, Tailwind CSS) — hero, product pages, and blog live at ketapay.com.
- ▶ Ketapay's product backend runs on Supabase Edge Functions powering the platform's data and user layer.
- ▶ Owned QA for MVP1: installed sandbox builds via TestFlight and tested the complete escrow flow — funding, holding, release, and every fallback UI state — from the user side and against server-side behavior.
- ▶ Logged 150+ clear, reproducible issues in Linear across the MVP1 cycle, then worked a find → log → fix → verify loop with engineering through successive TestFlight builds. MVP1 shipped to production with those defects caught and resolved before any customer saw them.
- ▶ Grew into a core engineering and product role: architecture decisions, feature design, and input into the platform's technical direction as a founding team member.
- ▶ Drove product vision, translating secure-escrow requirements into prioritized engineering work and intuitive user journeys across design, engineering, and operations.

Independent Web Builds — Supabase-Backed Sites

Freelance / Personal Projects (Next.js · TypeScript · Supabase)

- ▶ Cozy Handmade artisan e-commerce brand: landing page and storefront built with Next.js and Supabase.
- ▶ Personal portfolio website (Next.js · Supabase).

Front-End Engineer — Scalable TypeScript Refactor (MVP)

2023

OneStop Solutions

- ▶ Refactored a critical production module to TypeScript, enforcing strong type safety and eliminating runtime type errors.
- ▶ Designed a modular, reusable architecture integrable across multiple applications, improving development efficiency and consistency.
- ▶ Established standardized, self-documenting code patterns that improved developer onboarding.

Web Developer — Construction Company Website

Sep 2023 – Dec 2025

Nalot Multisystems Limited

- ▶ Developed and deployed a responsive WordPress/PHP website: service listings, project showcases, blog, and validated, spam-protected contact forms.
- ▶ Optimized performance and SEO, improving page-load speed and search rankings to boost lead generation.
- ▶ Managed hosting, domain, backups, and SSL, with ongoing post-launch support and feature updates.

Software Developer — Office Management App

Apr 2022 – Jun 2023

Nalot Multisystems Limited, Abuja

- ▶ Contributed to an office-operations platform including an attendance clock-in system.

- ▶ Implemented staff authentication with role-based access to internal data for viewing and managing profiles.
- ▶ Organized and structured company data to support efficient, streamlined operations.

ICT Support & Digital Learning Facilitator

Apr 2021 – Apr 2024

Digital Economy Learning Centre — NITDA, Nigeria

- ▶ Deployed and maintained connectivity for learning centres nationwide (KU-band, 3 Mbps down / 2 Mbps up).
- ▶ Installed e-learning infrastructure, locally hosted SaaS learning material, networked systems, and HUAWEI IdeaHub units across centres.
- ▶ Delivered hands-on digital tutorial classes to learners across the country.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- ▶ Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS
- ▶ Frameworks & Libraries: React, Next.js, Node.js, Spring Boot, Tailwind CSS, WordPress
- ▶ Backend & Data: Supabase (Edge Functions; Auth / Database / Storage), REST APIs, JWT
- ▶ QA & Testing: Playwright (end-to-end), Postman (API), AI-assisted exploratory browser testing via MCP (Chrome DevTools MCP + Claude Code), UI & system-flow testing, cross-device/browser verification, reproducible bug reporting
- ▶ Practices & Tools: Component-based architecture, state management, debugging & refactoring, Linear (issue tracking), TestFlight (beta distribution), Git/GitHub, Office 365

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.Sc. Zoology — Graduated with Honors

Kwara State University

2015 – 2019

Digital Regenesys (Awakening Potential)

Full-stack development with AI

2025- current

NIIT, Abuja

Master Mind Series

Full-stack – Development

2024-2025

INTERESTS

Football · Basketball · Board Games · Sky Diving